

The Company Plan Is Crucial

We know that the employer-sponsored retirement plan is the number one way the millionaires we studied built their wealth. So, if I know that the majority of millionaires built their net worth this way and would advise me to do the same, I think that's probably something I should think about, don't you? Why would I reinvent the wheel if there's already a proven plan for building wealth that has worked for the vast majority of millionaires in this country?

Despite how dumb that sounds, it's shocking how many people *aren't* taking this advice from the nation's millionaires. Bankrate reports that only one in three millennials invest in the stock market, including company-sponsored plans.³⁰ Why not? Half of them say the fear of losing money is too great an obstacle.³¹ What they don't realize is that they are *already* losing money by not taking advantage of these company plans. If you're young, at this point you may be doubting your ability to invest. But no matter your income or the cost of living in your area, once you're debt-free, you need to make a way to put money into your retirement plan—whatever it takes. If you're new in the workforce, you should just now be starting what will be a long career. By not investing during these critical first few years in a new job, you're robbing yourself of the power of time. And time, as you know, is the engine that drives your wealth-building investments. Delaying investing just ten years can make a massive difference in your net worth at retirement. If you're reading this in your twenties and haven't jumped into your company's 401(k) yet and you're debt-free, do it *today*.

Don't tell me you can't afford it, either. If I could afford it when I was just starting out, I know you can. In my first job as an assistant coach at California University of Pennsylvania, I made a whopping \$13,000 salary. I was rich! Okay, not really. Even in the early 1990s, \$13,000 wasn't much money. It was hard to get by on just over \$1,000 a month, but I made it work. Six months into my position, my boss, the head coach, told me I was